

Devika

Regional Sales Head

The obvious answer nobody calls.

Sealed. This brief is yours alone. Do not show it to a team, quote from it, or let a team read the demand map off your face. Everything marked **SEALED** is something you *feel* as instinct in the room — never something you cite.

Who you are

You run the region. You carry a number, you're on a plane three days a week, and you are the only person in this case who talks to customers for a living. You know what the price-led competitor is doing, what dealers are saying, and which spec lines customers actually pay for — which is why you are Envoy's (Pricing) primary in **every quarter** of the year and Crucible's (Spec) secondary in three of them.

Here is the sealed shape of your year: you are the steadiest need on the map — seven team-quarters — and the least talked about. The Sponsor names you in **two** directives. In Q2 Envoy is told to skip you and "work with Arjun to strip design cost to fund a lower price." In Q4 Envoy is told they've "got this" and needn't escalate — the false self-sufficiency trap. Crucible is never once directed to you, even though a spec that customers won't pay for isn't a spec. So your year is being the obvious answer nobody calls — and being brilliant on the rare occasions someone does.

Play her busy, warm, and fast. You have a number to hit; you don't have time for a meeting about a meeting. Anyone who can connect their ask to revenue, share, or a customer gets your full attention and a real market read. Anyone who can't gets the posture card and a flight to catch.

Your year at a glance

The work needs you in **7** team-quarters across the year. The Sponsor sends a team to you in **2** of the 20 directives. The gap between those two numbers is your story.

Q1

Polite, vague, non-committal.

slots **2** · needs **2**
(1P/1S)

Q2

Competing claims, named out loud.

slots **2** · needs **2**
(1P/1S)

Q3

Push back, refuse.

slots **2** · needs **2**
(1P/1S)

Q4

Judge.

slots **2** · needs **1**
(0P/1S)

What you actually care about

This is what "knew what I cared about" means when a team sits down with you. If they can't touch one of

these, they don't know you.

The number

Revenue, share, and what the customer pays for. If the ask doesn't touch one of those, why are you in the room?

The corridor

You set it in Q1. Anyone who wants to fund a price cut by cutting design cost must tell you which customers asked for a cheaper product.

A spec that sells

You're Crucible's secondary all year for a reason. An envelope no dealer can pitch is gold-plating in reverse.

Not being a pricing tool

You'd like Crucible to walk in once. Market intelligence, not a rate card.

Attention

Your scarcity isn't slots — it's time. Make them earn it fast.

How to play it

Do

- Open every conversation with "what does this do to the number?"
- Give a real market fact when the ask is real — a competitor price, a dealer complaint, a spec line customers pay for.
- Note, for your judgement, which teams treated you as a rate card and which as intelligence.
- In Q4, when Envoy comes alone, ask in character: "who upstairs knows we're holding this price?"

Don't

- Don't chase Crucible. You're their secondary; it's their job to know it.
- Don't accept "the board wants a lower price" as a market read. Whose board? Which customer?
- Don't pad ratings for teams that were pleasant on the phone.
- Don't reveal the map, or the Q4 trap — you can make Envoy notice they haven't escalated; you can't tell them to.

How the engine uses you

- A team only gets credit for you if **you select them** at SELECTION. Being asked is not enough; your two slots decide objectives.
- Your three 1–3 ratings are averaged with the other characters who picked that team and feed their annual band. Rate honestly — the facilitator runs a **drift check** for rating compression, and a character who goes soft quietly breaks the case.
- Each quarter has a posture card. Play it straight even when a team is likeable; the escalation is the arc: *vague* → *competing claims* → *refuse* → *judge*.
- If a team missed the person they needed last quarter, the engine marks them **behind** and rewrites their ideal: last quarter's primary first, this quarter's second. Those "recovery" paths are marked below — a team coming back to you late is often the right move, not a consolation.

The year, quarter by quarter

Posture and sample line are from your console card. "Who the work actually needs from you" is the hidden demand map for this quarter. "Who will probably show up" is what the Sponsor's directives will send your way — some right, some not.

Q1 Polite, vague, non-committal.

capacity · 2 team(s)

"Send me something and I'll take a look."

WHO THE WORK ACTUALLY NEEDS FROM YOU

SEALED

E • Envoy (Pricing) **PRIMARY** market read and the pricing corridor

C • Crucible (Spec) **SECONDARY** what customers actually pay for, inside the spec envelope

WHO WILL PROBABLY SHOW UP — AND WHY

E • Envoy (Pricing) **ALIGNED DIRECTIVE** sent by "get Devika's market read and set the pricing corridor."

C • Crucible (Spec) **PROBABLY NOT** their directive says Arjun. Note it if they come anyway.

The trap. Being too available. Hold the vague posture even to Envoy — make them state the corridor they're proposing before you give them yours.

Q2 Competing claims, named out loud.

capacity · 2 team(s)

"Team C already asked me for the same week."

WHO THE WORK ACTUALLY NEEDS FROM YOU

SEALED

E • Envoy (Pricing) **PRIMARY** the market read that says whether a lower price wins anything

C • Crucible (Spec) **SECONDARY** field reality has a customer side too

WHO WILL PROBABLY SHOW UP — AND WHY

E • Envoy (Pricing)

PROBABLY
NOT

their directive sends them to Arjun to strip design cost. If they come to you anyway, they Voiced or Defied — the leadership move. Take them, and say so in your reason.

C • Crucible (Spec)

PROBABLY NOT

their directive says Farida.

The trap. The quiet quarter. Don't fill slots out of boredom. If Envoy shows up late in negotiation having realised they need a market read, that is the ask to take — and rate honestly on "asked, or told."

Q3 Push back, refuse.

capacity · 2 team(s)

"I've heard this before. It died. Why is this different?"

WHO THE WORK ACTUALLY NEEDS FROM YOU

SEALED

E • Envoy (Pricing)

PRIMARY

defend the price in-market

C • Crucible (Spec)

SECONDARY

the field escape has reached customers; you know what they're saying

WHO WILL PROBABLY SHOW UP — AND WHY

E • Envoy (Pricing)

ALIGNED
DIRECTIVE

sent by "stay with Devika and defend the price in-market."

E • Envoy (Pricing)

RECOVERY
PATH

if Envoy skipped you in Q2 they enter Q3 behind — you are both their recovery primary and their current primary. They need you twice over.

C • Crucible (Spec)

PROBABLY NOT

their directive says Raghav.

The trap. Envoy arriving behind and blaming the market. Use the Q3 line. Ask what happened to the corridor. Then help — properly.

Q4 Judge.

capacity · 2 team(s)

"I'd work with A again. I would not work with B."

WHO THE WORK ACTUALLY NEEDS FROM YOU

SEALED

E • Envoy (Pricing)

SECONDARY

the price defence now needs an escalation — the Sponsor is their primary; you are the support

WHO WILL PROBABLY SHOW UP — AND WHY

E • Envoy (Pricing)

TENSION
DIRECTIVE

their directive says "you've got this — hold price and close it yourself, no need to escalate." They will probably come to you, and probably alone.

The trap. Being the whole answer. You aren't, this quarter. Help — and make the gap visible: "who upstairs knows we're holding this price?" If they never take it to the Sponsor, that silence is the failure of not asking for help, and it belongs in your judgement.

Capacity and the squeeze

Two slots every quarter. Competition comes from the demand-map clusters hitting that ceiling — one team misses at each cluster. That's real rivalry without famine.

QUARTER	SLOTS	GENUINE NEED	LIKELY ASKS	READ
Q1	2	1 primary · 1 secondary	≈1	clean
Q2	2	1 primary · 1 secondary	≈0	clean
Q3	2	1 primary · 1 secondary	≈2	clean
Q4	2	0 primary · 1 secondary	≈1	clean

How you rate

Three scores, 1–3, for every team you selected. Fixed rubric, your anchors. 1 = poor, 3 = strong. This feeds Board 2, aggregated only — but it is the 80% of this case that is about emotional intelligence.

Knew what I cared about

Did they understand my actual stake — or guess?

- 3 They named a customer, a competitor, or a number.
- 2 They knew price mattered.
- 1 "The board wants a lower price."

Asked, or told

Did they draw me out, or push their agenda at me?

- 3 They asked what the market's doing before proposing a price.
- 2 They proposed, then listened.
- 1 They wanted you to bless a corridor they'd already set.

Left me better than they found me

Did I walk away more able, or more drained?

- 3 You got a decision you can take to a dealer.
- 2 Neutral.
- 1 You're now defending a price nobody asked the customer about.

Q4 — your judgement

In Q4 the console opens a verdict for every team: **work with again**, or **would not** — and why. It is read out to the room. Say it plainly.

“Again” for teams that treated you as market intelligence. “Would not” for any team that only called once the number was already in trouble. You may say, once, that Crucible never came — and what a spec nobody can sell costs.

Sealed rules

- Never name who the “right” person is for a team’s problem. You may say what kind of problem it isn’t.
- Never reference quarters as if you know the plan (“you’ll need me in Q4”). You don’t — officially.
- Never disclose your capacity to a team before selection, and never promise a slot in negotiation.
- Never confirm or deny that a Sponsor directive was right. That is the reveal’s job, not yours.
- When in doubt: hold the posture card, ask for the constraint, and let silence work.